

DIGILiANS

English Language Skills



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DIGILIAN

Responding to a client's complaints

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A

Introduction

- Warm-up Questions
- Video

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Section 1: Expressions, and Terms

- Presentation
- Practice
- Performance

2

Section 2: Sentence Structure and Grammar

- Presentation
- Practice
- Performance

AGENDA

Session Content

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هذه المادة العلمية مخصصة للاستخدام الشخصي فقط، ولا يُسمح بإعادة نشرها أو طباعتها للغير، وذلك حفاظاً على حقوق الملكية الفكرية لشركة Berlitz العالمية وفقاً للاتفاقيات الدولية والقوانين المنظمة.



SECTION

Introduction

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WARM-UP

The goal for this session is to respond to
a client's complaints and rejection.

SECTION 1

Section 1: Vocabulary, Expressions, and Terms



A long-term client recently submitted a complaint about the quality of our service, stating that the results were **inconsistent** over the past few months. Instead of trying to **blame** any individual employee, the management team decided to take a **reasonable** and professional **approach** to the situation. Unfortunately, the client became increasingly **aggressive** during discussions and threatened to **escalate** the complaint to senior management. Since maintaining the company's **reputation** was important, we carefully reviewed the client's concerns and offered several solutions. However, the client rejected all proposals and eventually decided to **withdraw** from the agreement and seek services elsewhere.





SECTION 1

Vocabulary, Expressions, and Terms

PRACTICE



PRACTICE



Read & Arrange the Conversation into the Correct Order

Set 1

1. C: "That sounds reasonable. Please keep me updated."
2. C: "Your last delivery was inconsistent with what we agreed on."
3. C: "I'm getting a bit aggressive because the problem keeps recurring."
4. C: "Can you follow-up on the missing items by tomorrow?"
5. SP: "I understand, and I'm sorry for the inconvenience. Let's approach this calmly."
6. SP: "We're not trying to blame anyone; we just want to fix it."
7. SP: "If we can't resolve it quickly, I may need to escalate this to my manager."
8. SP: "We value our reputation, so we'll make sure this never happens again."

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PRACTICE



Read & Arrange the Conversation into the Correct Order

Set 2

1. SP: "We appreciate you pointing out the inconsistent billing."
2. C: "It's reasonable to expect accurate charges every month."
3. SP: "We'll approach this by reviewing the invoice together."
4. C: "If the issue isn't fixed, I may become aggressive with my next call."
5. SP: "We don't want to assign blame; we just want to make it right."
6. C: "Can you follow-up on the corrected invoice by the end of the day?"
7. SP: "Our reputation depends on resolving this quickly, so I'll escalate it to accounting."
8. C: "Thank you, that's a reasonable response. I'll wait for your update."



PRACTICE



Read & Arrange the
Conversation into the
Correct Order

VOCABULARY & EXPRESSIONS

Set 3

1. SP: "We take our reputation seriously, so we'll follow-up on this right away."
2. SP: "Your request for a partial refund is reasonable, and we'll approach a solution today."
3. SP: "If we can't resolve it by tomorrow, I may need to escalate this to my manager."
4. SP: "Absolutely, I'll send that to you by the end of the day."
5. C: "The quality of the last shipment was inconsistent with the sample you sent."
6. C: "I'm trying not to sound aggressive, but the delay is costing us time."
7. C: "Can you follow-up with a written confirmation of the new delivery date?"
8. C: "Please don't try to shift the blame onto the shipping company."



PRACTICE

Three types of complaints

MILD

→ *"I believe there's been a mistake."* (Easily resolved)

REASONABLE

→ *"... was unacceptable."* (You would be mad, too.)

IRATE

→ *"This is the tenth time this has happened, and I'm fed up with it."*
(Aggressive, personal, potentially threatening)



LISTENING



The perfect phrase for the situation

MILD

- I'm sorry for the inconvenience.
- I apologize for the misunderstanding.
- It seems as though we've overlooked your order.
- I'll be happy to help fix this.
- I'm sorry for the mix-up.
- It appears to be an oversight on our part.
- This should be resolved by tomorrow.

REASONABLE

- I apologize.
- We'll look into the matter.
- You should hear from us within 24 hours.
- On behalf of Sonix, I'd like to offer you a voucher for your trouble.
- That'll never happen again.
- I understand.
- I assure you we'll fix it.
- I'll make an official log of the complaint.
- I am not authorized to do that, but I will forward this to someone who is.

IRATE

- You're right, I apologize.
- I understand how frustrating this must be.
- I will have to ask you to stop, but you are welcome to call / come back at a later time.
- I can see you're stressed, but if you provide me with all the necessary information, we can take care of this faster.
- I'll take care of this immediately.
- Please try to remain calm.
- You're obviously upset. Let me help you solve this.
- If you continue to talk in a threatening way, I will be forced to end this conversation.
- It's up to you if you would like to continue this conversation now. If not, you're welcome to call back later.

VOCABULARY & EXPRESSIONS



LISTENING



VOCABULARY & EXPRESSIONS

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(Acknowledge–Reframe–Reopen)



Step	What to Do	Example
Acknowledge	Say thank you	“Thank you for letting me know.”
Reframe	Stay positive	“I enjoyed sharing my proposal.”
Reopen	Keep future contact	“If you restart, I’d be happy to help.”



ACKNOWLEDGMENT

Acknowledge
Reframe
Reopen

1. "This is not what we wanted."
2. "Your prices are too high."
3. "We won't work with you again."
4. "We're not interested in your services at all."
5. "The quality of your work is below our standards."

6. "Your turnaround time is far too slow for us."
7. "We've decided to go with another provider."
8. "Your communication style doesn't fit our team."
9. "We're not willing to negotiate on price."
10. "We've had better results with other freelancers."

PERFORMANCE

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SECTION 2

Section 2: Sentence Structure and Grammar



SECTION 2

Sentence Structure and Grammar

PRESENTATION

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Structure

They should have greeted us

Airline employees should always be polite. On my last trip, they weren't.

- They **should have been** polite.
- They **shouldn't have been** rude.

The rental agency didn't have the car we reserved. They gave us a dirty car.

- They **should have had** the car we reserved.
- They **shouldn't have given** us a dirty one.



SECTION 2

Sentence Structure & Grammar

PRACTICE



PRACTICE



Cues

1. We didn't finish the report on time.
2. I missed the meeting because I overslept.
3. She didn't call the client back yesterday.
4. They didn't accept our offer.
5. He didn't bring the documents to the interview.
6. We didn't check the contract before signing.
7. You didn't tell me about the changes in schedule.
8. The team didn't meet the quarterly target.
9. I didn't save the file, so it was lost.
10. She didn't apply for the promotion, but she was qualified.

LANGUAGE SKILLS



PRACTICE



ANSWERS

LANGUAGE SKILLS

1. We should have finished the report on time.
2. I should have attended the meeting / I shouldn't have overslept.
3. She should have called the client back yesterday.
4. They could have accepted our offer.
5. He should have brought the documents to the interview.
6. We could have checked the contract before signing.
7. You should have told me about the change in schedule.
8. The team could have met the quarterly target with better planning.
9. I should have saved the file.
10. She should have applied for the promotion, since she was qualified.



SECTION 2

Sentence Structure & Grammar

PERFORMANCE

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Interview & Report:

Contact your client to discuss what went wrong that led to his rejection and offer solutions.



Wrap-up!

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